Tumor Necrosis Factor-Alpha Stimulates IKK to Drive NF-kB Nuclear Translocation

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Page 1 — Abstract & Introduction

Tumor necrosis factor-alpha (TNF-alpha) is a master regulator of acute and chronic inflammatory responses. TNF-alpha stimulates the IKK complex through receptor adaptor proteins.

Page 2 — Signaling Mechanisms

Activated IKK phosphorylates IkB-alpha, triggering its polyubiquitination and proteasomal degradation.

Page 3 — Results: Transcription

Degradation of IkB-alpha liberates NF-kB dimers, promoting NF-kB nuclear translocation and binding to target gene promoters.

Page 4 — Results: Cytokines

Nuclear NF-kB strongly upregulates IL-6 and IL-8 expression in vascular endothelial cells.

Page 5 — Discussion

We conclude that TNF-alpha drives IL-6 production via sequential IKK activation and NF-kB translocation. Pretreatment with vehicle did not alter cytokine levels.